

SAASH Verdict Summary

Eight independent analysts, each gated behind live research and none seeing another's work, reviewed a 14-slide investor introduction for a pre-revenue beauty-technology company raising \$20M.

30 AUGUST 2026 5 PASS · 3 CONDITIONAL · 0 INVEST NOT FINANCIAL ADVICE

Worth showing investors? Yes — but not this deck, for this ask.

The document is well made. Sourcing discipline is above average for the stage, the tariff work is exact, the factory costing is honest, and slide 14 states *"No revenue yet. The risk is execution and demand."* Sending it out will get meetings. It will not get a \$20M term sheet — and the reason is not polish. **Three load-bearing claims do not survive contact with public information**, and an investor will find at least one in the first meeting. **The price is what breaks, not the product** — which is the good news, because price is the one variable the founders control.

~30% Going concern & self-funding in 5 years	~10% Venture-scale outcome, ≥3x	~70% Fails or becomes a zombie	0.80x Expected MOIC at ~\$80M post	1.8x Expected MOIC at ~\$35M post
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01 — SCOREBOARD

Nobody would invest at the stated ask

ANALYST	MANDATE	VERDICT	CONF.	ONE LINE
CAC & acquisition		PASS	85%	"Slide 11 assumes a 100% attach rate and calls it a business model."
Retention & attach		PASS	84%	"At 8% attach and \$140 CAC the cohort returns 0.96x. It needs 91% to reach 3:1."
Sensor science & IP		PASS	82%	"The sebum sensor as described may not be physically possible."
Competitive response		PASS	78%	"Slide 8's matrix is falsified by three companies, one named on the slide."
Ask & team		PASS AT \$6M	85%	"Priced like a Series A, staffed like a pre-seed."
Base rates & omissions		PASS ≤\$25M PRE	75%	"Nobody will ask what jurisdiction the shares are issued in."
Manufacturing & margin		CONDITIONAL	72%	"The costing is honest. The \$790 price is a demand bet dressed as a margin achievement."
Regulatory & claims		CONDITIONAL	72%	"The calendar is off by nine months and the Cold Sore claim is live liability today."

02 — THE THREE FALSIFIABLE CLAIMS

Any competent associate can find these

CLAIM 1 · SLIDE 8 — THE MOST DANGEROUS

"Across all seventeen, the first two columns are empty" is false

FOREO — listed on the slide — has shipped the BEAR since 2019, reading skin electrical resistance 100–200×/second and auto-adjusting intensity. That is both "empty" columns. **Nu Skin's Prysm iO** (Q4 2025) takes 70,000+ hyperspectral measurements per scan; the deck files Nu Skin under "none of the four." **Amorepacific's Skinsight** (CES 2026, with MIT) isn't among the seventeen at all. Two sealed agents falsified this independently, via different companies.

The deeper problem is worse than the error: the columns are empty because **the category tried this and retreated**. Neutrogena killed the SkinScanner hardware and went camera-only in Jan 2020 — the exact inverse of SAASH's thesis, by the company that tried it first. P&G dissolved Opté in Jan 2023 despite a 20,000-person waitlist. HiMirror bricked every unit in March 2024.

CLAIM 2 · SLIDE 9

The sebum sensor, as described, may not be physically possible

The Sebumeter SM 815 is not a sensor. It is grease-spot photometry — a consumable matte tape read by a photocell. No established solid-state contact sebum sensor exists. So either the reading is a proxy described as corneometry-grade measurement, or **the device ships a consumable and slide 12 is missing a cost line** — in which case the recurring-revenue gap partly solves itself. Hydration by capacitance is real, but a commodity Shenzhen module. Separately, no trial anywhere tests LED protocols adapted to hydration or sebum, and the best-powered relevant RCT found LED improved wrinkle volume but *not* hydration.

The model silently assumes a 100% attach rate

"THE CUSTOMER SO FAR — \$960, net +\$512" is presented as a property of the model. It is an unlabelled assumption set to 100%. Health & beauty leads all verticals at 21.5% first-to-second purchase, but **77% of second purchases are reorders** — a mechanism a durable device doesn't have. Realistic attach: **3% low / 8% base / 15% high**. Order two isn't free either (~18% retargeting and promo), so contribution is \$347, not \$489. **Rebuilt at \$140 CAC and 8% attach: LTV/CAC 0.96x**. Reaching 3:1 needs ~91% attach.

Where the deck is right, and the common critique is wrong

The \$135 ex-factory cost is plausible – arguably conservative

The intuition that 2,000-unit minimums should produce worse unit costs is reasonable but wrong here. Independent bottom-up BOM lands \$85–155 ex-factory. They quote their *worst* cost point. *Caveat: tooling and certification are likely excluded, so true first-run cost is nearer \$150–175.*

The 40.1% tariff decomposes exactly

2.6% MFN on HTS 8543.70.96 — the correct classification — plus 25% §301 List 3 plus 12.5% §301 forced-labor. Careful, verifiable work. *But "margins that survive a 40% tariff" is trivially true: ex-factory is 17% of retail, so 10 points of duty costs 1.7 points of margin.*

The margin gap has an honest answer the deck doesn't give

"We're DTC" doesn't explain it — **TBTG is >90% DTC and still 62.7%**. The real answer: **SAASH prices at \$790 a device costing roughly what a \$395–650 device costs**. A demand bet, not a margin achievement. Saying so is stronger, because it converts an unanswerable question into an answerable one. One point in the deck's favour: **every figure on slides 11 and 12 ties exactly**. The arithmetic is clean; the inputs are the problem — an assumptions problem, not a rigour problem.

CAC × attach, not CAC

CAC is paid on returned orders too, which slide 11 ignores. At the deck's own 10–12% returns provision, \$80 becomes ~\$90 per retained customer — so order one nets **+\$13, not +\$23**, and break-even is \$92–103. The claimed \$80 sits only 22% below its own break-even.

Note the nuance the "CAC kills it" framing misses: at \$150 CAC the model does *not* invert — it needs ~10% attach, near the base rate. The fatal variable is **CAC × attach**, and the deck discloses neither.

Regulatory adds nine months, not cost. Observed 510(k) reality is 142–175 calendar days with ~67% receiving information requests that stop the clock. Earliest US clearance is **Q2–Q3 2027** against stated Dec 2026 dates — while 35% of the raise buys inventory against those dates.

CAC	ORDER - 1	ATTACH TO B/E	LTV/CAC @8%
\$80	+\$23	0%	1.68x
\$120	–\$17	3.5%	1.12x
\$150	–\$47	9.6%	0.90x
\$200	–\$97	19.8%	0.67x
\$250	–\$147	30.1%	0.54x
MONTE CARLO, 200K RUNS		AS DRAWN	MASK-FIRST
Median LTV/CAC		0.84x	1.33x
P(≥1.0x — returns cash)		32%	81%
P(≥2.0x — scalable)		1.3%	12%

The single highest-value change: invert the ladder — lead with the \$790 mask

The demand is in masks (SharkNinja alone sold >\$70M in 2025 against a \$35M tracked category — the deck's own slide 4). Down-sell beats a 4.6× trade-up. There's no margin argument for leading cheap — mask contribution (61.9%) already exceeds Blemish (60.5%). And the fatal contradiction: **only the mask has the sensors**, so leading with Blemish means the data asset — the entire defensibility case — doesn't begin until an order two that fewer than 10% of customers place.

A \$3–6M seed story presented as a \$20M Series A

CAN IT WORK?

Yes as a business — probably not as a \$20M venture investment. ~30% it becomes a real, profitable company, and 40–45% with the fixes below. LYMA does ~\$48M sales and ~\$7M EBITDA selling devices direct; that's the achievable shape of success, and a good outcome for the founders. But ~10% returns a venture fund — and the deck's own comp caps it: **TBTG listed at 2.1x revenue**, so \$20M needs >\$200M revenue to return 10x, a business larger than TBTG at listing.

UNASKED, AND MATERIAL

- **The data asset has a settled precedent against it** — Neutrogena Skin360's \$4.7M BIPA settlement, approved Feb 2026.
- **Cash cycle is 230–300 days** — one inventory turn a year. Only the \$6M marketing line converts into demand.
- **"A single UAE entity"** names no ADGM or DIFC, where liquidation preference is enforceable.
- **No financial model at all** — no forecast, burn, runway, valuation or cap table.

FIX BEFORE THE DECK LEAVES THE BUILDING — DAYS

- 1 **Rewrite or delete slide 8.**
- 2 **Rewrite the Cold Sore claim.** Live liability today.
- 3 **State SAASH's own regulatory status** and who owns the clearance.
- 4 **Label slide 11's attach rate** with sensitivity.
- 5 **Explain the margin instead of asserting it.**

BEFORE THE RAISE — WEEKS

- 1 **Invert the ladder** — lead with the mask.
- 2 **Cut the ask to \$4–6M**, one market, tranching on milestones.
- 3 **Add a topco** in ADGM/DIFC or Delaware.
- 4 **Hire regulatory/hardware before commercial.**
- 5 **Prove CAC with \$50–100k** before raising on it.

The strongest version of this pitch

One market, one device — the mask — a real CAC number from ninety days of live spend, a filed 510(k), and a \$5M ask. **That deck raises. This one gets meetings and then loses them in the room.**

Five questions that end the meeting — have answers to all five before sending anything

1. "What percentage of \$170 Blemish buyers does your model assume buy the \$790 mask, and over what window? Show me slide 11 rebuilt at 6%." *A killing answer: "we assume they all do," or "we haven't modelled it separately."*
2. "FOREO's BEAR has adjusted intensity from a skin-resistance reading since 2019, and it's on your slide 8. Walk me through that cell."
3. "Is the sebum measurement a solid-state sensor or does it use a consumable? If solid-state, what is the operating principle?"
4. "What is SAASH's own 510(k) status on each device, and who owns the clearance — the UAE entity or the factory?" *Note K242593, the CurrentBody clearance you cite, is held by Shenzhen Kaiyan Medical.*
5. "What jurisdiction are the shares issued in, and how does my liquidation preference get enforced there?"